Milton Keynes Restorative Principles in Practice Initiative

A Whole School Practice Framework

Good relationships - The heart of all learning.

Interim Report - March 2011

Overview:

This report draws together outcomes and key findings from the schools forming phase one of this initiative; eleven in total. It will be further supplemented, where necessary, following a round of additional evaluative visits during 2011. There are currently 23 schools participating. The latest group of six, which includes three schools from the secondary sector, joined in September 2010. Requests from schools for inclusion in the programme continue to be received. The current scheduling and allocation arrangements for additional schools in November, January and February 2011 will increase the total to 29.

Aims of the Restorative Principles initiative:

- To provide a unifying practice framework for all adults within a school community: to build, strengthen and manage relationships at all levels, using a common language and consistent practices that place good relationships at the heart of the school community.

- Contribute to improvements in the overall effectiveness of participating schools:
  Raise outcomes for groups and individuals
  Improve the quality of provision
  Build Leadership capacity

Strategy:

- Engage with Headteachers and Senior Leaders in each school before commencement
- Introduce the Restorative Principles Framework to all adults within each school community
- Develop and embed principles and practice through an ongoing local lead practitioner programme
- Build leadership capacity and sustainability through networks of local leaders and site based consultancy
- Identify impact measures - Monitor, evaluate and report on progress

And the difference is?

Outcome Based Accountability

Do the framework's principles and practices impact on adult management of relationships: building inclusive learning communities that improve pupil's enjoyment and well being, along with readiness and willingness to participate and learn – Improving overall effectiveness and Every Child Matters outcomes.

Each participating school was asked to consider impact measures relevant to their individual school improvement priorities. For evaluation and reporting purposes outcomes were then grouped under the following strands; each then illustrated with tables and supporting commentary

1. Whole school level - Relationship improvement priorities
2. Case studies - Individual pupils and/or small groups
3. External verification - OFSTED inspections, SIP verification and Attainment Outcomes

Evaluation strands:

Whole School Priorities	Pupil Case Studies	External verification
Behaviour incidents reported at Break times	Exclusions for individuals	OFSTED Inspection findings compared to previous inspections
Behaviour incidents reported at Lunchtime	Progress of individuals and groups	SIP verification and comparison to previous visits
Pupils removed from class due to disruptive behaviour	Individual progress against behaviour support plans	EYFS Percentage of pupils achieving 78+ st 6+ in PSD
Involvement of Senior staff in dealing with behaviour incidents	Interventions and referrals to learning mentors	EYFS Percentage of pupils achieving 78+ st 6+ in CLL
Pupils excluded from class/ group activities and privileges	Individual Pupil Case Studies	KS1 - Percentages achieving L2+ in Speaking and Listening and Writing
Time lost to disruptive behaviour		

Section 1: Whole School Themes

Is the framework improving adult management of relationships - Strengthening community and providing learning opportunities when tension, conflict and inappropriate behaviour occur?

Priority Area	Number of Schools	Group average Start	Group average Current	Group Difference	Group % Reduction
Behaviour Incidents reported at Lunch time (day)	8	12.3	1.5	10.8	87%
Incidents reported at break times (day)	8	6.5	1.4	5.1	78%
Incidents referred to HT or Senior Leaders (day)	9	5.25	0.75	4.5	86%
Pupils removed from class (day)	5	5.2	0.6	4.6	88%
Pupils losing allocated privilege time (Weekly)	5	16.5	0.75	15.75	95%
Time lost to disruptive behaviour (Hours per week)	1	9.9	4.1	5.8	57%

Commentary

Headteacher and Senior Leaders

• Significant improvement in staff consistency - 'The language we use is changing for the better'
• There is now a willingness and readiness to learn amongst pupils that wasn't always there before
• Significant reduction in low level disruption, and quicker resolution of incidents...which do not usually reappear.
• Calmness in the school that wasn't there in September 2009
• Pupils now know they will be listened to and not judged
• Reduction in Lunchtime incidents is very significant,' feels like it's 100 times better'

• 10 minutes lost every day following lunchtime is now not needed
• Only 1 four day exclusion this term - The previous term we had 30 exclusion sessions
• Significant improvement in pupils feeling that they can talk to other adults in school and will be heard. Previously 41% - Now 62%
• The language and practice has made a significant difference to the staff of this school
• Staff really see the benefit of circles
• Adults on playground now make a significant impact at lunchtime by applying the Restorative Interventions
• Time consuming to start with but now is much quicker, with many pupils now using the process and language to sort out problems

Lead Practitioners and Staff
• Pupils understand meaning of sorry and appreciate the fairer system - they say 'We are listened to'
• Pupils readily talk about how they feel and have made others feel
• Pupils value their opportunity to input in to the restoring process
• Pupils are prepared to be honest
• Staff are calmer and more reflective
• Our KS2 results were the best ever - This is the result of community building circles, with what I initially found a difficult Y6 class in September 2009
• This training has changed my whole approach to behaviour - 'I now know it's all about my practice'
• We now have NO persistent offenders
• In EYFS there is a significant increase in pupils' readiness and willingness to learn

Stantonbury Campus.
Stantonbury Campus joined the initiative in July 2010. The implementation programme, planned with senior leaders, focused initially on establishing and developing a core team of 15 leading practitioners made up from staff across the school. On completion of the four session lead practitioner programme, the framework's principles and practices will be outlined to all staff during the November professional development day. The school's Lead Practitioner Team will then begin the roll out training and support programme.

Initial feedback from Stantonbury's Lead Practitioners: (October 2010)
'… good relationships are the foundation for effective learning. We see restorative principles in practice as an excellent way to ensure that this happens. Already the training sessions have given staff methods in the classroom and in their interactions, which promote a feeling of cooperation and inclusion. It is giving staff, in a variety of roles, the opportunity to practice how they can role model the method of working with students to others. We have also seen staff dealing more effectively with confrontational adolescents.'

Summary

Every Headteacher, their Lead Practitioners and staff available for interview, report the significant positive impact of the Restorative Principles framework in building a respectful whole school ethos of social responsibility. They note in particular the significant contribution to social cohesion and the resulting enhanced levels of student engagement, along with willingness and readiness to learn. Adults report the significant impact of the Framework on their individual approach to relationship practices. The outcomes clearly demonstrate that adult management of relationships continues to improve, as practice is embedded and secured. One Headteacher undertook with her staff a detailed survey of time lost to disruptive behaviour before embarking on the framework training – Across the whole school 19 hours and 47 minutes were lost over a typical two week period. One year later that time has reduced to around 4 hours 6 minutes per week.

Section 2: Individual Case Studies
Participating schools recorded the impact of the Restorative Principles Framework on vulnerable pupils:

a. Pupils whose progress was a cause for some concern

This table illustrates average points progress made in one year by a group of ten, year two pupils.
On average pupils are expected to achieve 3 points per year.

	Reading		Writing		Maths	
Pupil	**July 2009**	**June 2010**	**July 2009**	**June 2010**	**July 2009**	**June 2010**
A	7	11	7	11	9	13
B	7	17	9	15	7	17
C	11	15	9	13	11	17
D	13	15	11	15	11	15
E	3	9	3	9	9	15
F	7	11	3	3	11	13
G	11	17	7	15	7	15
H	11	13	9	13	9	13
I	7	11	7	13	7	11
J	7	15	7	15	9	17
Group average start/end	8.4	13.4	7.2	12.2	9	14.6
	Average difference = +	5.0 points	Average difference points	= + 5.0	Average difference = +	5.6 points

Commentary:

Average improvement for all subjects is approximately 66% above national expectations. Staff at this school introduced and embedded community building circles in their teaching and learning practice; enhancing provision in terms of engagement and inclusion and creating a readiness and willingness to learn. It is clear that the rich dialogue created within community circles accelerates progress, particularly of vulnerable groups and improves learning outcomes. Community building circles are a significant strength of the practice observed in all project schools.

b. Pupils who have been or are at risk of exclusion:

Pupil and issue	Exclusion days Start	Exclusion days Current
A Disruptive Behaviour class, break and lunchtime	18	0
B Violent towards others	6	0
C. Disruptive often removed from class	2	0

Commentary
Teachers and Teaching assistants when interviewed reported
Y2 Pupil - Waits his turn in the Restorative Circle - And can talk about who has been affected and how - He is now learning and making good progress
Y3 Pupil - Last year he was very difficult but he now readily conforms to values of our group... because of the relationships we have created as a class community
Y3 Pupil - Although displays occasional disruptive behaviours he is beginning to understand the process and 'loves' the way he is now listened to and not judged by adults
Y6 Pupil who presented very challenging behaviour - He now talks about how he has learned to listen and understand how his behaviours affects others - The Dramatic change in his relationships with his peers has led to him being voted vice captain of his house

Y6 Pupils who were continually falling out over football often resulting in inappropriate violent conduct now hold their own restorative interventions when issues arise - which are very rare.
Y2 Pupil - I have noticed that he is now listening to adults and children rather than losing his temper as before and storming off.

Summary

The Restorative Principles framework, when applied as a whole school philosophy, will transform the climate for learning for all groups, particularly vulnerable pupils. The framework's practices when used by all adults within the school community strengthen inclusion and equality of opportunity, leading to significant progress in personal and social development, and improved progress rates for vulnerable groups; narrowing the gap, particularly for those at risk of exclusion from the school community. The contribution of circles, and conversations with a focus on social consequences, are clearly evident in terms of pupil well being and, as a result, learning outcomes for all pupils in the school community.

Adults report, since adopting the framework, significant impact on their day to day practice; bringing greater clarity and understanding and, as a result, improved consistency to relationship management. In one school there has been one, four day exclusion during this current term, where during the previous (summer) term 30 exclusion days were recorded.

Pupils comment on the fairness of adult practice, ' I feel I am listened to' and, 'I feel treated fairly' and, 'I always have a turn to speak' are the common responses from pupils who have been involved in restorative interventions.

Adults also comment on pupils' willingness and readiness to accept responsibility for their actions, take the opportunity to learn from an incident and make things right. Some adults have been surprised by the maturity shown by some of their more challenging pupils in both community building circles and restorative interventions, but recognise that it is their own practice, in both building and managing relationships, that is bringing about positive changes in the behavior of some vulnerable individuals. Schools overall, as illustrated by the above tables, report that increasingly their more challenging pupils are learning to take responsibility and want to put things right, with some groups resolving issues themselves without adult intervention, using the restorative language and practice modelled for them by adults in the school.

Section 3 External Verification:
OFSTED Inspection Findings

Participating schools inspected towards the end of the first year of the project. This table compares previous and latest inspection grades

School:	St Monica's		Shepherdswell		Langland		Heronsgate*	
Grades	**Previous**	**Current**	**Previous**	**Current**	**Previous**	**Current**	**Previous**	**Current**
Care guidance and support	2	1	1	1	3	2	2	1
Pupil Behaviour	2	1	1	1	3	3	2	1
Effectiveness with which school promotes equal opportunities and tackles discrimination	3	2	2	1	3	3	2	1
Effectiveness of the school's engagement with parents	3	2	2	1	3	2	2	1
Achievement - Quality of pupil learning and progress	3	2	3	1	3	3	2	1
How Effective is teaching and Learning	3	2	2	2	3	3	2	1
Capacity to Improve	3	2	2	2	3	2	N/A	N/A
Leadership and Management	3	2	2	1	3	2	N/A	N/A
Overall Effectiveness	3	2	2	1	3	3	N/A	N/A

* Heronsgate received a one day Personal and Social Development aspect inspection

Inspection report extracts

St Monica's

- Care, guidance and support are outstanding, so that pupils behave extremely well and are sensible and enthusiastic learners.
- Pupils say they feel extremely safe because relationships are excellent and they can discuss with adults any problems they have.
- Pupils thoroughly enjoy coming to school and their attendance is excellent.
- Behaviour is outstanding and pupils are sensitive to the needs of others.
- Pupils needs are central to the work of the school and all adults effectively help children...to get the best from learning
- Equality of opportunity and elimination of discrimination are effective, as reflected in the profile of good achievement

Shepherdswell

- Pupils behave exceptionally well and say they feel entirely safe at school because of the outstanding care, guidance and support that members of staff provide. As one pupil put it, 'We don't get sad much, but when we do, there is always somebody to make things better.'
- Rates of attendance and the number of pupils doing well for their age in their reading, writing and mathematics have improved..
- Pupils appreciate and follow the school's behaviour code and are skilled at solving moral dilemmas.
- Pupils work extremely well, either on their own or in groups and pairs. They are deeply concerned for the welfare of their classmates and highly tolerant and supportive of those who have special educational needs and/or disabilities.
- All members of staff care deeply about the pupils and are totally committed to their welfare.
- The inspection team found that behaviour was outstanding and that children's needs were exceptionally well met.

Langland

- The headteacher, senior leaders and governors are particularly successful in advancing aspects of care, guidance and safety.
- 'We love this school. It helps us learn. We like all the lessons and the trips. We feel very safe in school. Our teachers care for us very much. This school is great.'
- Pupils enjoy school and lessons because they like and respect their teachers.
- The school's ethos is friendly, warm and welcoming, and relationships are good
- Pupils feel very safe and secure in school and are confident that adults will help them if they have any concerns.
- Care, guidance and support are strong so pupils develop a positive attitude to school and to learning
- Strong relationships contribute to a positive climate in which pupils enjoy learning.

Hersongate:

- Behaviour is outstanding, pupils are confident caring and considerate

• Pupils value each other's contributions
• The Inspector observed Community Circles and reported on the positive impact on relationships and quality of practice observed

External Verification continued

Achievement and Progress:

This section of the evaluation seeks to provide additional verification of the contribution made by the Restorative Principles framework to overall effectiveness, alongside existing school improvement initiatives.

Outcomes for groups and individuals:

The table below records the average outcomes across participating schools between 2008/9 and 2009/10.

Early Years Foundation Stage Outcomes at 6+

The % pupils achieving 6+			
	2008/09	2009/10	% increase
Personal Social Development	78.5	85.9	9.4%
Communication Language & Literacy	59.6	73.4	23.1%

Key Stage One Outcomes:

Percentage of pupils achieving	Group Average 2008/09	Group average 2009/10	% Difference
Level 2+ in Speaking and Listening	81%	86%	+ 5%
Level 2+ in Writing	75%	80%	+ 5%
Level 2 + in Reading	81%	82%	+1%

Summary

A key impact noted by Headteachers, OFSTED, staff and parents is the improvement in pupil's readiness and willingness to learn; particularly where community building is embedded across a school. Regular, planned community circles clearly develop inclusion and equality of opportunity, whilst supporting improved outcomes in both EYFS and KS1, particularly relating to communication, language and literacy skills, along with personal and social development. There is also emerging evidence, yet to be substantiated, of increased rates of progress particularly in basic skills at KS2..

The initial impact in EYFS, particularly CLL, is significant and results from the community building aspect of the framework where language is modelled, vocabulary is extended and learning is created through dialogue. Similar trends in attitudes to learning across KS1 and KS2 are evident and the impact at KS1 builds on the key areas noted in EYFS. Evidence of impact on KS2 will be included in the updated report

Conclusion: Is the Framework contributing to improved overall effectiveness in the project schools?

The interim evaluation demonstrates what is possible, in terms of improved outcomes and effectiveness for all groups of pupils when:

Adults working in a school are able to:

Articulate explicitly the basis of their professional practice and that of their organisation.

Model language and practices that promote consistency in the management of relationships, at all levels.

Schools secure a learning culture where:

There is a relentless focus on building social responsibility. Developing a shared understanding and commitment to agreed values, reinforced with high challenge and support.

Incidents of conflict and wrongdoing, to individuals or the wider community, provide an opportunity for learning.

Responsibility for personal choices is relentlessly pursued through acknowledgment of harm, along with the responsibility for putting things right.

In terms of both the quantitative and qualitative outcomes it is clear that the Restorative Principles Framework is making a significant positive contribution in the drive to further improve and secure overall school effectiveness. OFSTED inspection outcomes, and report commentary, support the views held by Headteachers and their staff that when Restorative Principles are implemented, as a whole school improvement philosophy, significant improvements in terms of overall effectiveness are achieved and sustained. Restorative principles and the practice standards have contributed to rapid and significant positive impact on both whole school improvement priorities and, in particular, vulnerable groups and individuals. The initiative provides schools with a framework to evaluate existing personal and organisational relationship practices, acknowledge and improve what is already working, and challenge and replace ineffective practices.

The difference is…

Adults consistently employ a professional practice framework that ensures relationships are always the heart of learning and teaching.

Emerging priorities and next steps for consideration:

Current schools

Enhance training and support programmes for existing Lead Practitioners through local networks
Flexibility to respond to individual school requests for additional support
Provide bespoke training programmes for schools when requested
Support for school leaders with implementation through network meetings and consultancy

Aspirations

Identify, develop and secure local trainers and leaders of Restorative Principles across the Authority
Establish a core team of Leaders, trainers and training schools in key localities of the Authority
Training programme availability to any school where improving learning community is identified as a school improvement priority
Engage with other Children's Service Leaders – And make the full training programme available where need is identified
Establish leaders and trainers in services other than schools
Provide Leadership training and consultancy

Acknowledgements

Sincere thanks are extended to all schools involved in the initiative for their commitment, and the drive needed to ensure practices are not only developed but secured and embedded within their schools.

In Particular:

- Headteachers for their leadership, direction and the permissions needed to make practice a reality for the pupils in their schools*
- Lead practitioners for their infectious enthusiasm, creativity and dedication that has maintained momentum and guided practice developments in their schools.
- Leading Authority Officers, who in partnership with Headteachers, have provided strategic direction, obtained financial support and provided the accountability framework.

* The initial eleven schools represent approximately 2,700 pupils – Currently the project is working with 24 schools, with the potential to affect the lives of around 8,500 pupils in Milton Keynes.

PaulCarlile
Restorative Principles in Practice

In Partnership with Headteachers and Local Authority Officers in Milton Keyne

Paul has a vast range of experience in education; A former Headteacher and OFSTED Inspector who gained national recognition for his work in the North East of England, where he then became a regional School Improvement Advisor. Recently Paul acted as consultant and trainer to the City of Hull Restorative Practices initiative. His passion is supporting, through bespoke restorative training and consultancy, Headteachers who seek innovative school improvement solutions, but expect practicality, relevance and significant impact.

Paul is best known in the UK, and overseas, for his contributions to school improvement, and latterly for his significant contribution to the Restorative Practices initiatives in both Hull and Milton Keynes. Where his commitment to innovation, contributed to significant positive outcomes for those involved; gaining Schools and the City of Hull in particular national and international recognition.

Paul and his colleagues deliver comprehensive school improvement programmes across the UK and overseas; working in partnership with leaders who seek to close the gap between practice and aspiration. Paul speaks about his work at national and international seminars and conferences.